

Chapter 6

Own It Millionaires Take Personal Responsibility

We have a crisis of responsibility in this country today. More and more, it seems like we as a society care more about *assigning blame* for our problems than *finding solutions* for our problems. Can't get a job? It's the economy's fault—even if you never went to college and haven't read a book since high school. Can't lose weight? It's the food industry's fault—even if you've never worked out and eat nothing but fast food. Can't get ahead financially? It's the wealthy's fault—even if you've maxed out credit cards and car loans to support your high-end lifestyle. Can't win a game of golf? It's because of the wind. Rear-end another car at a stop light? It's because the other guy hit the brakes too fast. Fail a test? It's because the teacher's out to get you. Does any of this sound familiar?

Ronald Reagan once said, “We must reject the idea that every time a law's broken, society is guilty rather than the lawbreaker. It is time to restore the American precept that each individual is accountable for his actions.” That doesn't seem likely in our culture today. We love holding *others* accountable for our missteps. However, while personal responsibility seems completely MIA in many circles, there's one population where it is not only evident but also dominant: America's everyday millionaires. The men and women we studied have embraced personal responsibility in a way we haven't seen anywhere else, and that sense of responsibility is driving them up to and beyond the millionaire mark.